

6.11 Developing an MVP

ایم وی پی بناتے وقت صرف ضروری خصوصیات چنیں؛ سب کچھ ایک ساتھ بنانے سے کام مشکل، مہنگا اور سست ہو جاتا ہے۔

CS XII

Chapter 6: Entrepreneurship in the Digital Age

Lecture 12 of 16

6.11 Developing an MVP

LEARN IT

To develop an MVP, the team must **select only the essential features**. Extra features should be avoided at the beginning. A common mistake is **trying to build everything at once**. This makes the product **difficult, costly, and slow**.

An **MVP plan** should clearly explain: the **problem, target users, main feature, basic design, estimated cost, marketing method, feedback method, and improvement plan**.

Table 6.8: MVP planning checklist

MVP Element	Question to Ask	Example Answer
Problem	What problem are we solving?	Students wait too long at canteen.
Target users	Who will use it first?	Grade XII students in one college.
Main feature	What is the ONE feature that solves it?	Pre-order snacks before break.
Basic design	What steps are needed?	Menu, name, class, order time.
Cost	What free/low-cost tools to use?	Google Form or printed slips.
Marketing	How will early users hear about it?	WhatsApp message to class group.
Feedback	How will users respond?	Short feedback form after 3 days.

The eighth element, the **improvement plan**, answers "What will we change after feedback?" (you will see it in the case study in 6.12).

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked example: filling the checklist for a new idea. Idea: a college notice reminder for parents in Hyderabad (from Table 6.1).

MVP Element	Answer
Problem	Parents miss college notices (fee dates, PTMs, holidays).
Target users	Parents of first-year (Class XI) students of one college.
Main feature	Send each notice to parents' phones on the same day.
Basic design	Photo of notice + 2-line summary in Urdu and Sindhi + date.
Cost	Free: WhatsApp broadcast list from the college office phone.
Marketing	Students give a printed slip to parents with the number to save.
Feedback	After 2 weeks, a 3-question voice-note or phone survey of 20 parents.
Improvement plan	If parents say notices come too late, send a reminder 1 day before each date.

Notice: only **one** main feature, a **free** tool, and a clear way to collect feedback.

REMEMBER IT

Mnemonic for the 8 elements: "People Try My Bakery; Cheap Muffins Find Improvement": Problem, Target users, **M**ain feature, **B**asic design, **C**ost, **M**arketing, Feedback, Improvement plan.

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: Writing a list of ten "main features".

Fix: The checklist asks for the **ONE** feature that solves the problem. Everything else waits until the MVP proves people want it.

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CHECK YOURSELF

1. Why is building everything at once a mistake?
2. List the eight elements of an MVP plan.
3. In Table 6.8, what is the marketing method?

Answers: 1. It makes the product difficult, costly and slow. 2. Problem, target users, main feature, basic design, estimated cost, marketing method, feedback method, improvement plan. 3. A WhatsApp message to the class group.

Extra board practice

These MCQs and questions are extra to the textbook. Close the notes, attempt them, then open the key.

MCQ 1. Developing an MVP means:

- a. Choosing only essential features and a way to deliver them
- b. Hiring 40 engineers first
- c. Designing 12 themes
- d. Writing the TOS of a unicorn

MCQ 2. A feature is essential if:

- a. The core job fails without it
- b. A competitor has it
- c. It is AI
- d. It is animated

MCQ 3. Manual-behind-the-scenes is allowed if:

- a. The user still gets the job done (concierge MVP)
- b. You lie that it is fully automatic forever
- c. You skip users
- d. You skip ethics

MCQ 4. Time-box the build to:

- a. Days/weeks, not years
- b. A decade
- c. Until perfect
- d. Until the logo shines

MCQ 5. You still need:

- a. A way to measure the learning
- b. No metric
- c. Only likes
- d. Only press

MCQ 6. Extra features before the core works are:

- a. Waste
- b. Professionalism
- c. Required by BIEK
- d. HCI law

Extra short questions

1. Steps to develop an MVP from the notes.
2. Concierge MVP meaning.
3. Tools a student can use.
4. One ethics line.

Extra long question

1. Turn the notes-exchange idea into an MVP plan: features in/out, tools, 7-day schedule, metric, kill-criteria.

Extra answer key

MCQs: 1. A 2. A 3. A 4. A 5. A 6. A

Short

1. Core job, essential features, drop extras, pick tools, build, measure.
2. You perform the service by hand (WhatsApp) while pretending the “product” exists — to test demand.
3. Forms, sheets, WhatsApp, JazzCash, a landing page.
4. If you take money, deliver or refund; don't ghost testers.

Long

1. In: list+request. Out: chat/AI. Tools: sheet+group. Metric: 10 completed exchanges. Kill if <2. Schedule table.

Next lecture: 6.12 Case Study: MVP for a Canteen Pre-Order System